of it. The unsuspecting consumer assumes that he gets additional benefit in terms of free gifts, discounted price as introductory offer. But the product is sold at the usual price. Sometimes the consumer is forced to take certain goods as free gifts whether he needs them or not.



vi) Substandard Quality

A wide range of products of different sizes and qualities are available in markets. The consumer finds it difficult to choose with confidence, in a market where spurious spare parts of equipment, and adulterated foods are easily available.



In addition to cheating the consumers, the products of substandard quality also create a safety problem for them. Imitations are so cleverly manufactured that there is no way to tell that they are spurious. Such fake copies of originals can lead to serious hazards besides being expensive in terms of replacement costs and fuel use.

ACTIVITY 1

Collect any two advertisement which offers free gift and record your comment regarding the offer.

vii) Incorrect Weights and Measures

Receiving less than what a consumer pays for, has been an age old problem. This type of problems usually occurs in case of food ingredients liquids such as oils and milk and dry items like rice, pulses. The measuring of fabrics is also affected. Very often the cloth to be measured is stretched while measuring, resulting in higher costs for the consumer in addition to having less cloth for stitching a garment.

As a result of the government's efforts of standardising weighing and measuring equipment and stepping up inspection of the weights and measures used in the market, the problem of under weighing or measuring is significantly less than what it was a few decades ago.



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